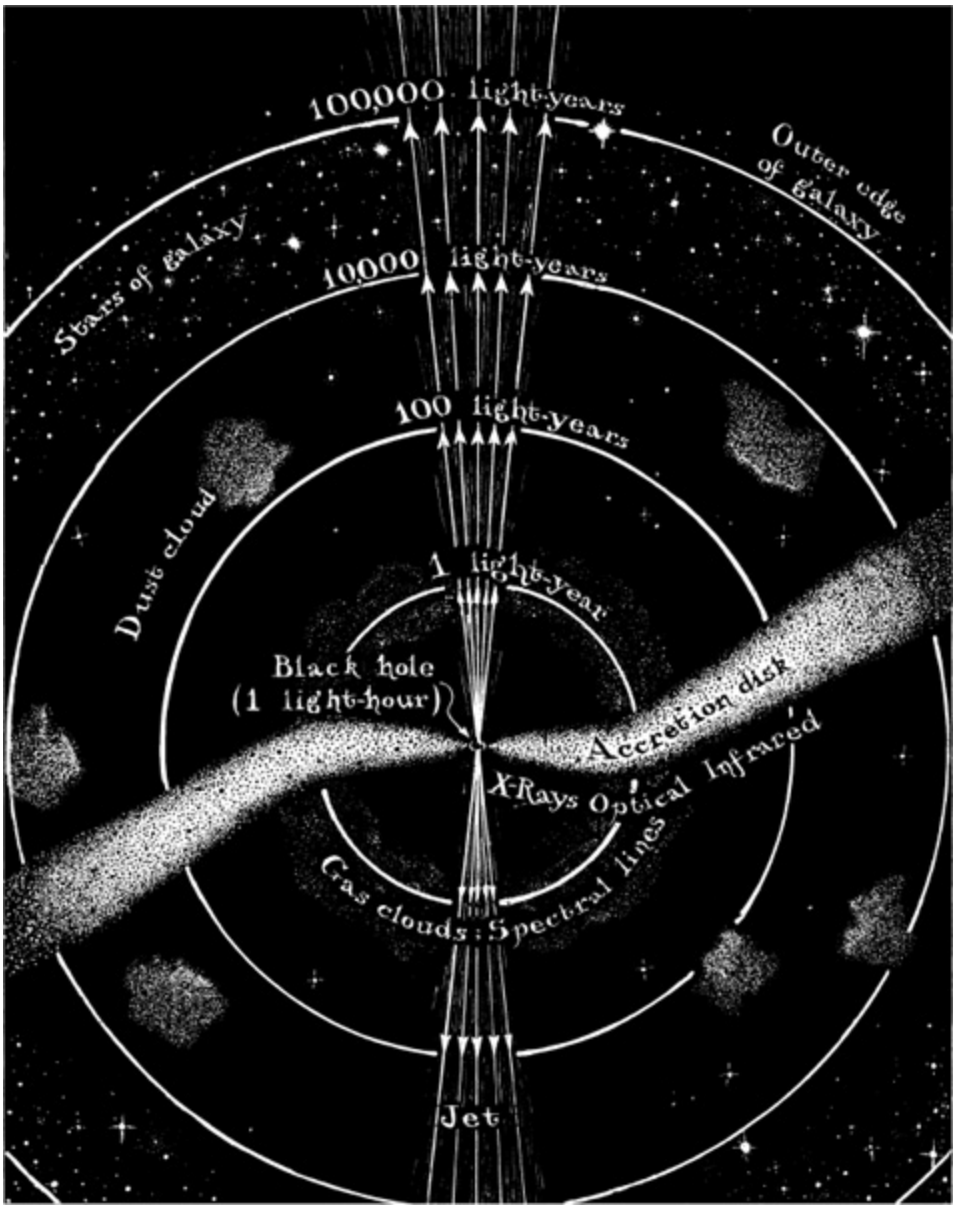



**9.8 Our best present understanding of the structures of quasars and radio galaxies. This detailed model, based on all the observational data, has been developed by Sterl Phinney of Caltech and others.**

In a radio galaxy, by contrast with a quasar, the central accretion disk presumably is rather quiescent. Quiescence means small friction in the disk, and thus small heating and low luminosity, so that the disk shines much less brightly than the rest of the galaxy. Astronomers thus see the galaxy and not the disk through their optical telescopes. However, the disk, the spinning hole, and magnetic fields threading through the hole together produce strong jets, probably in the manner of Figure 9.7d (the Blandford–Znajek